

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Flurries 35/21 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 40/32 **B6**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

MONDAY, DECEMBER 8, 2025 • \$4

Staff flag dangerous errors in VA records

Hospitals' new computer system causes delays in treatments, drug mix-ups

BY **DESMOND BUTLER**
AND **ORION DONOVAN SMITH**

On the eve of a major expansion, a multibillion-dollar project to upgrade the computer systems of all Department of Veterans Affairs hospitals is beset with problems, according to some medical staff who already use it. Critical patient notes disappear. Prescriptions log the wrong dosages. One nurse said the system incorrectly listed one of her patients as dead.

Mike Faught, a case manager at Mann-Grandstaff VA Medical Center in Spokane, Washington, said he lost access to his patients' records for two days after a software update in August. "It's amazing to me that there are still so many problems," Faught said. "Every time there's an update, there are unintended consequences."

The program launched in 2018 to replace the aging computer system used across VA's health care network, which serves more than 9 million veterans, with an off-the-shelf product that could handle many of the same tasks: organizing important information including appointments, referrals, prescriptions and patient histories.

After the system went live in 2020 at Mann-Grandstaff, doctors and other users began flagging errors that caused delays in treatment and medication mix-ups, and grappling with a system that was routinely offline, according to

SEE **VETERANS** ON **A4**

U.S. youth have bleak views of the future, new survey shows

Gen Z's trust in politics is low as AI drives fears about job prospects

BY **GAYA GUPTA**

Is Gen Z all right? According to a new poll from the Harvard Kennedy School Institute of Politics, maybe not.

More than 40 percent of 18-to-29-year-olds surveyed last month said they are struggling or just getting by, and one-quarter believe they'll be worse off financially than their parents. Many distrust the White House and Congress, both major political parties and, to some extent, each other. And while most reject political violence, nearly 40 percent say it is acceptable under certain circumstances.

The message is clear, said John Della Volpe, the institute's director of polling: The systems and institutions meant to support young Americans no longer feel stable or responsive to them, and they are fearful for what comes next.

"Young Americans right now have no clue what the future holds, and are deeply concerned about that," said Jordan

SEE **POLL** ON **A2**



COURTESY OF KARL BUSHBY

BY **SYDNEY PAGE**

Karl Bushby made a barroom bet that he could walk from the southern tip of South America all the way home to England. His friends had little faith.

"Suddenly, it became a challenge," Bushby said of the bet he made in his 20s. "That conversation gathered steam, until eventually I did the math and thought, 'This is doable.' ... I became semi-obsessed with what it would take to achieve something like this."

A few years later, in 1998, he stood at the edge of Punta Arenas, Chile — about as far from his hometown of Hull, England, as a person can get on foot — ready to begin a 31,000-mile expedition he thought would take roughly 12 years.

It's been 27 years, and Bushby, now 56, is still walking.

"The plan was to do something pretty extraordinary," he said.

27 years ago, Karl Bushby set out to walk around the world.

HIS QUEST IS NEARLY OVER.

Karl Bushby hiking in Ecuador in 2000 on his 31,000-mile Goliath Expedition.

He's walked through Patagonia, the Andes, Central America, Mexico, the length of the United States, Russia, Mongolia and parts of Asia. He's traversed some of the most remote, hostile and politically fraught places on earth, and crossed deserts, jungles and war zones.

At the start of his quest, Bushby made two rules for himself, neither of which he has broken.

"I can't use transport to advance, and I can't go home until I arrive on foot," Bushby said. "If I get stuck somewhere, I have to figure it out."

He initially mapped out the walk by hand.

"Back in those days, it was all paper maps and pencils and a calculator," he said.

Bushby's trek — which he has called the Goliath Expedition — has taken far longer than he anticipated because of financial

SEE **EXPEDITION** ON **A18**

Mom of Leavitt's nephew rejects portrayal after ICE arrest

BY **MARIA SACCHETTI**
AND **TODD WALLACK**

From her confinement in a remote detention center in Louisiana, Bruna Ferreira recounted all the ways she said she has tried to maintain a friendly relationship with the family of White House press secretary Karoline

Leavitt. After all, Ferreira shares a child with Leavitt's brother.

The Brazilian immigrant selected Leavitt to be her son's godmother. She signed off on her son's trip to the White House Easter egg hunt this spring. And she said she "moved mountains" to ensure he could attend Leavitt's wedding in January.

Arrested Nov. 12 by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, Ferreira, 33, said it is insulting to sit in orange prison scrubs facing possible removal to Brazil after spending most of her life in the United States while the Trump administration paints her as a criminal. She is being detained for being in the U.S. States

illegally, a civil violation, after overstaying a visa when she was a child.

"I asked Karoline to be godmother over my only sister," she said Thursday in a video interview with The Washington Post. "I made a mistake there, in trusting. ... Why they're creating this

SEE **LEAVITT** ON **A13**



BRAD REMPEL/IMAGN IMAGES

A miserable afternoon

Jayden Daniels (5) and the Commanders did little against Andrew van Ginkel and the Vikings on offense before the quarterback left the 31-0 defeat after he was shaken up again. **Story, C1**

Business of caregiving for older Americans faces deepening crisis

Funding cuts and staffing shortages have driven up prices amid high demand

BY **SHANNON NAJMABADI**

Jonas Atta-Kyereme helps 85-year-old David Reese dress in the morning and prepare for bed at night. He makes sure the retired pediatrician takes his medicine, and calms him when he gets anxious looking for his wife, Jane, who died last year.

It's a typical shift for Atta-Kyereme, a caregiver who began working in Reese's home after the older man sustained a traumatic brain injury during a fall last year.

"He needed 24/7 care," said Reese's brother-in-law George Sullivan. "He didn't even recog-

nize his own home that he'd lived in for 50 years."

Home health workers and caregivers such as Atta-Kyereme, who immigrated from Ghana two years ago, fill a critical role in the health care ecosystem as America ages and demand for caregivers soars. But government funding cuts, a caregiver shortage and immigration limits are layering new strains on an industry already hard-pressed to meet demand: Home health and personal care openings are projected to jump 17 percent from 2024 to 2034, according to data from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, and home health spending is expected to nearly double, to \$317 billion, in 2033.

Costs are fast increasing: Spending on at-home elder care shot up 7 percent from August to September, the largest monthly

SEE **HOME HEALTH** ON **A6**

BUSINESS NEWS.....A15
CLASSIFIEDS.....C13
COMICS.....B4

HEALTH & SCIENCE.....D1
METRO.....C10
OBITUARIES.....C11

OPINION PAGES.....A16
SPORTS.....C1
STYLE.....B1

TELEVISION.....B6
WEATHER.....C18
WORLD.....A7

CONTENT © 2025
The Washington Post / Year 149, No. 54424



0 70628 21100 3

There's information. And then there's Intelligence.

Discover the difference with WP Intelligence
Visit wapo.st/wpi to learn more

wp Intelligence

Powerful insights. Exclusive access.